California - business Insurance - Guidelines

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Purpose and authority

Internal Business insurance operating guidelines for California (CA). Apply only within delegated underwriting and claims authority. These standards do not create coverage, replace policy wording, or establish government requirements.

Application and eligibility

Record legal entities, operations, locations, revenue, payroll, headcount, property values, vehicles, subcontractors, contracts, prior losses, and requested lines. Verify business classification and refer hazardous operations, complex ownership, and material overseas exposure.

Coverage design

Evaluate property, general liability, business income, commercial auto, workers compensation, professional liability, cyber, and umbrella needs. Not every line is included in a business package. Record named insureds, locations, limits, deductibles, waiting periods, exclusions, and endorsements.

Risk engineering and contracts

Review fire protection, equipment maintenance, fleet controls, workplace safety, subcontractor transfer, data security, and continuity plans. Route contractual indemnity, additional insured, waiver, and certificate requests to authorized reviewers. Certificates do not amend coverage.

Claims handling

Capture affected entities, locations, operations, injury or damage, potential third parties, downtime records, and immediate mitigation. Preserve relevant evidence. Escalate employee injury, cyber incidents, litigation, environmental issues, and multi-policy coverage questions.

State risk review

For California (CA), screen for address-level flood, severe weather, fire, theft, liability, and service interruption exposure; wildland interface, smoke, evacuation access, and vegetation management where relevant. These are internal screening priorities, not a finding that a particular location has the exposure. Validate the individual risk with current evidence.

Decision record and quality control

Record the CA jurisdiction, product, form version, evidence, coverage discussion, referral decision, approver, and communication history. Require a second review for authority exceptions. Keep internal business rules separate from legally required rules and retain the evidence under the approved retention schedule.

CA / business / Guidelines | Owner: Insurance Operations and Compliance